

# BURNING ALL FUEL RESERVES WILL INITIATE THE RUNAWAY GREENHOUSE

## ENVIRONMENTAL FEEDBACK LOOPS

### IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

**James Hansen** (1941–)

BEFORE

**1875** In the book *Climate and Change,* Scottish scientist James Croll describes the climate-warming feedback effect of melting ice.

**1965** Canadian biologist Charles Krebs discovers the “fence effect,” showing vole populations protected from foxes rocketing, then crashing.

**1969** American planetary scientist Andrew Ingersoll highlights the “runaway greenhouse effect” that caused the planet Venus to heat up.

AFTER

**2018** Ecologists in Alaska predict that the accelerating release of methane from formerly frozen lakes will increase global warming.

All parts of an ecosystem are interdependent. Any species or habitat change will feed back into the system, and affect the whole of that system, including the part where it all started. In other words, the feedback travels around in a loop.